LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

lena.vargaholm@example.com | +385 55 555 0101 | github.com/lvh-data-example | lenavh.dev

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses across logistics, e-commerce and payments. Strong Python and SQL experience. Hands-on experience with AWS, Airflow, dbt, Snowflake, Kafka and Spark. Delivers reliable data pipelines, clear data contracts, tested transformations and scalable data models. Experienced in dimensional modelling, data quality, production platform operations, and open-source collaboration.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data platform and orchestration: Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Snowflake, PostgreSQL, pytest
Cloud and engineering: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions, CI/CD
Processing and data quality: PySpark, Great Expectations, JSON Schema
Data Warehousing, Modelling and BI: Snowflake, Redshift, dimensional modelling, Power BI, Looker (basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace) | Rijeka
03/2022–Present

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform, maintaining approximately 140 Airflow DAGs loading data from PostgreSQL, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated warehouse SQL transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt, delivering 420+ tested models; optimized the warehouse build and reduced nightly runtime from 5h10 to 1h50.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team using JSON Schema and CI checks, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately 9 to 2 per month.
- Designed and built a Kafka-based shipment-event pipeline using partner webhooks, Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming; processes around 30 million events per day with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95. Added dead-letter handling and replay tooling.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU usage during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced Snowflake spend from approximately 38k to 24k per month through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation (one week in six); mentor two mid-level data engineers and run weekly platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay (payments startup) | Zagreb
09/2019–02/2022

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw S3 files daily.
- Reduced finance team's manual reconciliation effort from approximately three days to four hours per month-end.
- Designed a Redshift star-schema warehouse with 30+ fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams.
- Established Great Expectations data quality checks for critical finance tables.
- Wrote an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Data Catalog access, adopted by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer | Adria Retail Group | Split
06/2017–08/2019

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL processes for an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron, making data loads easier to debug and change.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations across 40+ stores.

OPEN-SOURCE & COMMUNITY

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an open-source Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests (Python, pytest, 2023).
- Presented "Data contracts without the hype" at a regional data meetup in 2024.
- Teach SQL to beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) | Northgate Technical University | 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) | English (C1) | German (B1)